

Coniferous forests

Most conifers are tough trees that can cope with extreme weather conditions. Their hard, needlelike leaves do not dry out as easily as the wide leaves of broad-leaved trees, so they do well in hot, dry climates, such as around the Mediterranean. They can also withstand cold, icy winters—the largest coniferous forests are in Russia and Canada.



Needle leaves

Many conifers, such as pine trees, have leaves that are shaped like needles. However, some conifers have leaves that are straplike or scalelike. Almost all are thick, tough, and resinous.

Conifers grow tall and straight.

